

Toddler Tantrum Guide — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

REGULATE YOURSELF FIRST

- ☐ **Regulate Yourself First:** Take a deep breath and check your own emotional state before responding so you can stay calm and regulated during your toddler's tantrum.
- ☐ **Regulate Yourself First:** Remind yourself that tantrums are a normal developmental behavior and not a reflection of your parenting ability or your child's character.
- ☐ **Regulate Yourself First:** Stay physically present with your toddler during the tantrum without trying to immediately stop or fix their emotional outburst.
- ☐ **Regulate Yourself First:** Model calm breathing and emotional regulation for your toddler so they learn to manage big feelings by watching you stay steady.

RESPOND WITH CORE

- ☐ **Respond With CORE:** Validate your child's feelings with simple words like 'I see you're really upset' without trying to solve the problem while they're at peak intensity.
- ☐ **Respond With CORE:** Avoid reasoning, giving in to demands, unnecessary physical restraint, or shaming your child during the peak of a tantrum.
- ☐ **Respond With CORE:** Offer gentle regulation support by suggesting deep breaths or modeling slow breathing while staying nearby and calm for your child.
- ☐ **Respond With CORE:** Give your toddler empty space and time for the tantrum to naturally subside without rushing to stop it or fill the silence.

AFTER CARE AND RED FLAGS

- ☐ **After Care and Red Flags:** Once everyone is calm, talk with your toddler about what happened using simple words to help them name their feelings and build emotional vocabulary.
- ☐ **After Care and Red Flags:** Reconnect with your child through comfort and warmth after the tantrum ends before moving back to regular activities or discipline.

- ☐ **After Care and Red Flags:** Consult your pediatrician if tantrums last more than 15 minutes regularly, cause injury, or your child appears glassy-eyed and disconnected.
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- ☐ **After Care and Red Flags:** Identify one trigger situation this week and practice the CORE method before the next tantrum hits so you're prepared.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.